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Professor Marina Halac, Editor
Editorial Committee
Econometrica, Journal of the Econometric Society

Dear Professor Halac and Members of the Editorial Committee,

I respectfully write to ask whether the Editorial Office might consider granting a full waiver of the submission fee for my manuscript, which I am submitting in PDF format for your review: *Identifying Rational Types in Unknown Environments: The Case of Kidnapping for Ransom in Colombia*. I make this request with full respect for the journal's policies and editorial procedures, and only because I am not in a financial position to cover the submission fee.

I am a professor in the Economics Program at Universidad Colegio Mayor de Cundinamarca, a public university in Colombia, and a Ph.D. in Economics from Universidad de los Andes. My university does not finance this type of research project or the submission costs associated with it. The project has received no institutional or external funding, and I do not have a research budget or personal resources to pay the submission fee or, if applicable at a later stage, page-related publication costs.

The manuscript develops an indirect dynamic mechanism for identifying rational types in unknown environments, with an empirical and theoretical application to kidnapping for ransom in Colombia. It combines mechanism design, Bayesian learning, competing-risks econometrics, macroeconomic cointegration, and calibrated simulations. Its central contribution is an identification theorem showing how recurrent separation among observable signals can lead Bayesian beliefs to concentrate on the true type of a strategic adversary. The Colombian application supplies a substantive institutional setting in which the model is empirically disciplined by macroeconomic series, microeconomic hazards, and calibrated policy instruments.

I believe the paper is aligned with the analytical scope and standards of *Econometrica*: it proposes a formal economic mechanism, proves a theoretical identification result, and connects the theorem to data, estimation, and simulation in a setting of substantial social and economic relevance. If the manuscript is considered suitable after the editorial process, it would be a great honor for me to have this work published in *Econometrica*.

All supporting materials are available and organized, including the appendices, the working paper version, and the Streamlit application used to run the calibrated simulations. The complete repository is available on GitHub at:

<https://github.com/Donzhumber/rational-types-unknown-environments.git>.

I fully understand the journal's submission-fee policy and the importance of supporting the editorial process. My request for non-payment of the submission fee is made only because I do not have a

budget for this purpose and because my university does not fund projects or submission expenses of this nature. I would be deeply grateful if the Editorial Office could authorize the submission of my manuscript without payment of the fee.

Respectfully,

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